

expertise required to secure their systems makes it simply not worth it. This is hardly the case, especially for smaller organizations. In fact, a more effective recipe for information security success in SMBs is to spend less on unnecessary high-end security solutions and more on lower-cost technologies and educating employees on the various information security issues to be aware of when conducting business.

When using WLAN technology, it has become increasingly easier for hackers and other malicious users to hide their identity given that the physical boundaries of traditional wired networks are not present to serve as a layer of protection. This makes the art of hacking more appealing and therefore more prevalent. As if malicious hackers, spammers, and virus attacks aren't enough to encourage SMBs to take information security seriously, government entities throughout the U.S. and the world are forcing businesses no matter how small to adequately secure their information in the name of personal privacy and protecting corporate information. Regulations such as the Health Insurance Portability and Accountability Act (HIPAA) that affects the healthcare industry and the Gramm-Leach-Bliley Act (GLBA) that impacts the financial industry require strict information security controls for organizations in their respective industries as well as any organization that works with these entities as a business partner.

This can include accountants, consultants, lawyers, financial advisors, and more—expanding the requirements for solid information security practices throughout practically every industry. The bottom line is that computers, networks, and the Internet are now more complex than ever.

These complexities are introducing new security weaknesses that are being exploited in more ways—especially in the new realm of wireless computing. Regardless of the size of the organization or the network, information security principles are here to stay and will only become more demanding as we move further into the information age.